

Engineering College Cheat Sheet

Score any college in under 10 minutes · Compare three options side by side · Let the data — not the brochure — decide

Step 1. Fill Part A (parents) or Part B (student) for each college you're considering. **Step 2.** Fill Part C for each branch-college combo on your shortlist. **Step 3.** Add college score + best branch score in Part D. **Step 4.** Highest total wins. Tie? Branch score breaks it.

KEY FORMULAS — Calculate These Before Any Campus Visit

Fill Rate	Total students admitted ÷ AICTE-sanctioned intake × 100
Placement %	Students placed ÷ Total students enrolled × 100 (not just placement-registered)
Idle Output Index	(Total enrolled – Placed – Higher Studies) ÷ Total enrolled × 100
Median Salary	Middle salary from NIRF data — ignore the highest figure in the brochure

PART A — Parent Scorecard (10 Points)

Four data points every parent should check — all available on the NIRF dashboard.

Criterion	Max	0 pts	1 pt	2 pts	3 pts
Fill Rate	3	≤60%	61–70%	71–85%	>85%
Placement %	2	≤65%	65–80%	>80%	—
Median Salary	3	≤5 LPA	5–6 LPA	6–8 LPA	>8 LPA
Idle Output Index	2	>40%	21–40%	≤20%	—

Criterion	College 1	College 2	College 3
Fill Rate (/3)			
Placement % (/2)			
Median Salary (/3)			
Idle Output Index (/2)			
Total			

Total Part A: _____ / 10

PART B — Student Scorecard (15 Points) · Use if student visits campus

Same four criteria as Part A, plus **Campus Vibe /5** scored by the student. Vibe scoring: 0 = no impression · 1–2 = it was okay · 3–4 = felt good · 5 = loved it

Criterion	College 1	College 2	College 3
Fill Rate (/3)			
Placement % (/2)			
Median Salary (/3)			
Idle Output Index (/2)			
Campus Vibe (/5)			
Total			

Total Part B: _____ / 15

PART C — Branch Scorecard (10 Points)

Score the specific branch you are considering at each college. Fill in up to four combinations.

Criterion	Max	0 pts	1 pt	2 pts	3 pts	4 pts
Branch Placement %	3	≤60%	61–80%	80–90%	>90%	—
COEs for Branch	3	0	1	2	≥3	—
6-Month+ Internships	4	≤50%	—	51–70%	—	>70%

Criterion	Option 1	Option 2	Option 3	Option 4
Branch Placement % (/3)				
COEs for Branch (/3)				
6-Month+ Internships (/4)				
Total				

Total Part C: _____ / 10

PART D — Final Combined Score

Add college score (Part A or B) + best branch score (Part C). Use the same part for all three colleges.

Criterion	College 1	College 2	College 3
College Score — Parent (/10)			
Best Branch Score (/10)			
Parent Total (/20)			
College Score — Student (/15)			
Best Branch Score (/10)			
Student Total (/25)			
Final Rank			

QUICK TIPS

Fill Rate

Use AICTE-sanctioned intake — not today's class size. Quiet reductions hide poor demand.

Placement %

Ask: placed out of how many total? Include everyone enrolled, not just placement-registered students.

Idle Output Index

Above 30% = serious red flag. Below 20% = healthy. This number never appears in any brochure.

COEs

A Centre of Excellence for your branch = real investment. A name on a door means nothing.

Campus Vibe

Walk up to random students in the canteen. The college arranged some tours — talk to the others.

Tie-breaker

Same score on two colleges? The stronger branch score wins. That's closer to your actual career.